

The Best Places to Eat Bobotie

Jonkershuis Restaurant moderate

A historic setting in suburban Groot Constantia, South Africa's oldest wine estate, is just one of many reasons why a relaxed lunch at the Jonkershuis ranks among the Cape Peninsula's most iconic dining experiences. The setting here really is lovely, with long leafy rows of vines sloping up to the base of the ragged peaks of the Constantia Mountain, and the option of dining alfresco in the oak-shaded gardens. If this doesn't appeal, you can eat inside the period-furnished main building, a thatched and whitewashed Cape Dutch edifice dating to the 18th century. Owned and managed by a team of the Cape's most experienced restaurateurs, Jonkershuis prides itself on its Cape Malay menu, which includes *bobotie* – here served with an accompaniment of *sambals* (chili pepper sauces) and almond-flavored yellow rice. For those seeking a one-stop introduction to the local cuisine, the restaurant produces a sumptuous Cape Malay “tasting plate,” a kind of mini-buffet featuring *bobotie* alongside a rich lamb curry, a lighter chicken curry, and cinnamon-flavored roast butternut. There's a great choice of Cape whites, including the estate's own oaked Chardonnay and Sauvignon Blanc, and the dessert menu includes Cape specialties such as *melktert* (milk tart) and *malva* pudding, a spongy, apricot-flavored dish of Dutch origin.

Off Constantia Main Road, Cape Town;
open 9 AM–10 PM Mon–Sat; 9 AM–5 PM Sun;
www.jonkershuisconstantia.co.za

Also in Cape Town

The **Noon Gun Tea Room & Restaurant** (www.noonguntearoom.co.za; *inexpensive*) dishes up excellent *bobotie* along with the likes of *deningvleis* (a hearty sweet-sour lamb stew), chicken *breyeni* (a spicy rice-based risotto-like dish), and a good selection of characteristically sweet desserts to finish. Set in the world-famous Kirstenbosch Botanical Garden on the eastern slopes of Table Mountain, the **Silver Tree Restaurant** (www.kirstenboschrestaurant.com; *moderate*) is famous for its picnic hampers, but it also serves a good *bobotie* – made with super-lean ostrich meat in a traditional *potjie* (black pot) – and tasty Cape Malay curry.

Also in South Africa

Gramadoelas (www.gramadoelas.co.za; *expensive*) in Johannesburg has played host to luminaries as diverse as Queen Elizabeth II and the actor Danny Glover. *Bobotie* is a firm favorite on the menu, alongside other Cape dishes such as *waterblommetjebredie* (water-flower stew) and piping hot, grilled *sosaties*.



Above In 1954, the curried *bobotie* was declared the national dish of South Africa by the United Nations Women's Organization

Left The lines of colorful houses in the Bo Kaap Malay quarter are occasionally broken by *kramats* (Muslim saint shrines) and mosques